

Pistachio and raspberry opera cake

Prep Time: 10 min **Cook Time:** 3 hr

Ingredients

Pistachio joconde sponge

100 g almond meal

70 g icing sugar

50 g pistachios, very finely ground

3 large eggs

25 g plain flour

25 g unsalted butter, *melted*

3 egg whites

25 g caster sugar

Raspberry layer

250 g raspberries, fresh or frozen

50 g caster sugar

1 tbsp lemon juice

2 tsp cornflour

1 tbsp cold water

4 g gelatine (or 2 gelatine leaves)

Pistachio buttercream

100 g pistachio paste

100 g unsalted butter, *softened*

70 g icing sugar

1 tsp vanilla extract

Pinch of salt

1–2 tbsp cream, if needed

Chocolate ganache

150 g dark chocolate, *55-65*

150 ml cream

15 g unsalted butter

Raspberry syrup

75 g raspberries

50 g caster sugar

75 ml water



Chocolate glaze

100 g dark chocolate

15 g neutral oil or cocoa butter

Preparation Steps

Pistachio joconde sponge

1. Heat oven to 200°C conventional / 180°C fan.
2. Line a 23 × 33 cm baking tin with baking paper.
3. Whisk the almond meal, ground pistachios, icing sugar and whole eggs for 4–5 minutes, until pale, thick and fluffy.
4. Fold in the flour.
5. Fold in the melted butter.
6. In a clean bowl, whisk the egg whites until foamy. Gradually add the caster sugar and beat to medium-stiff peaks.
7. Gently fold the egg whites into the pistachio mixture.
8. Spread evenly into the tin. It should be quite thin.
9. Bake for 8–10 minutes, until lightly golden and springy.
10. Cool completely.
11. Cut into three equal rectangles.

Raspberry layer

12. Put raspberries, sugar and lemon juice in a saucepan.
13. Cook over medium heat for about 5 minutes, until the raspberries break down.
14. Mix the cornflour with the cold water.
15. Stir it into the raspberries and cook for another 1 minute.
16. Remove from the heat.
17. Stir in the softened gelatine.
18. Spread into a thin rectangle approximately the size of one piece of sponge.
19. Refrigerate until completely set.

Pistachio buttercream

20. Beat the softened butter and icing sugar for 3–4 minutes, until very pale and fluffy.
21. Beat in the pistachio paste.
22. Add vanilla and salt.
23. Add a little cream if the mixture is too stiff.
24. Beat until smooth.

Raspberry syrup

- 25.** Put the raspberries, sugar and water into a saucepan.
- 26.** Simmer for about 5 minutes.
- 27.** Strain through a fine sieve.
- 28.** Cool completely.

Chocolate ganache

- 29.** Chop the chocolate finely.
- 30.** Heat the cream until steaming but not boiling.
- 31.** Pour over the chocolate and leave for 2 minutes.
- 32.** Stir slowly until completely smooth.
- 33.** Stir in the butter.
- 34.** Cool until it becomes thick enough to spread.

Assemble the opera cake

- 35.** Place the first sponge layer on a flat board or tray.
- 36.** Brush lightly with raspberry syrup.
- 37.** Spread a thin layer of pistachio buttercream over the sponge.
- 38.** Carefully place the set raspberry layer on top.
- 39.** Add the second sponge layer.
- 40.** Brush lightly with raspberry syrup.
- 41.** Spread the chocolate ganache evenly over it.
- 42.** Add the final sponge layer.
- 43.** Brush very lightly with raspberry syrup.
- 44.** Spread a thin, even layer of pistachio buttercream over the top.
- 45.** Refrigerate for at least 1 hour.

Chocolate glaze

- 46.** Melt the chocolate gently.
- 47.** Stir in the oil or cocoa butter.
- 48.** Pour over the chilled cake.
- 49.** Spread into a very thin, perfectly smooth layer.
- 50.** Refrigerate until completely set.

Cut and decorate

- 51.** For very clean cuts, use a long sharp knife dipped in hot water and then dried.
- 52.** Cut into approximately 3 × 5 cm rectangles.

53. Decorate each with a tiny raspberry, chopped pistachio or a small piece of gold leaf.